

02/20/26

Free Talk

The Spring Festival Gala 春晚

gala /ˈɡɑːlə/ ★☆☆☆☆ | TEM8

N-COUNT A **gala** is a special public celebration, entertainment, performance, or festival. 节日盛会; 演出

- ...a gala evening at the Metropolitan Opera House.
...大都会歌剧院的庆祝晚会。

Draco Malfoy - 马尔福 - 马年尔等有福 (一个《哈利波特》梗)

Ramadan 斋月

fast / fasting 封斋/戒斋

Homework Analysis

Picture Description



新描述
In the picture, three people are walking up a snowy mountain while carrying snowboards. They are wearing winter jackets, helmets and gloves. The person in the middle is wearing a black and orange jacket ^{and is carrying} ~~with a~~ backpack. The person on the right is dressed in black and holding a white snowboard. The person on the left is ^{younger} ~~smaller~~ and ^{is} wearing a blue helmet, ^{with a snowboard in hands} ~~while carrying a snowboard~~. The ground is completely covered with thick snow. In the background, there are high mountains with snowy peaks and rocky ^{cliffs} ~~surface~~ under a clear blue sky. The sunlight comes from the right side of the picture, and the long shadows of the three people stretch towards the left on the snow.

The person in the middle is wearing a black and orange jacket with a backpack.

“背着书包” → carry a backpack

Why not “wear” or “with”??

* wear → 穿在身上的衣物 / 配饰

wear a jacket / wear shoes / wear glasses

* with → 语法正确 **BUT** 不能体现书包的状态

状态: 拿着? 背着? 放在旁边? → 表达不清楚 (毕竟图片描述要清楚描述出人和物的位置和状态)

The person on the left is smaller

The person in the middle is wearing a black and orange jacket **and is carrying** a backpack.

The person on the left is **younger**

and wearing a blue helmet, while carrying a snowboard.	and <u>is</u> wearing a blue helmet, with a snowboard in her/the person's hands.
---	--

① smaller

体型大小 (胖瘦、物体大小)

Forrest 想表达 “小”，是想说孩子 “年纪小”？

younger = 年龄更小 → 更符合语境

② carrying a snowboard → 原文其实有很多这样的表达了，建议换换

In the background, there are high mountains with snowy peaks and rocky <u>surface</u> under a clear blue sky.	In the background, there are high mountains with snowy peaks and rocky <u>cliffs</u> under a clear blue sky.
---	--

Cliff 更能表现出图片中山的自然地貌

surface 有很多不同的 surface，不够具体

新 新 作 文

Smaller Classes Is Better for Language Learning
are

(Nowadays, many parents and teachers are discussing whether students should learn languages in smaller classes.) 其实已经讨论过了 ?? why? Some people believe larger classes are easy to study in groups. YES! 这是一句话! While others argue that **WHERE?** BUT? students can receive more attention from teachers. From my perspective, smaller classes are more beneficial for language learning.

Firstly, students have more chances to speak in smaller classes. ① 和 ② 顺序 调换 ② When there are fewer students, each person has more time to answer questions and practise conversations. ① When learning languages It is very important for everyone to get take more speaking practice. For example, in a class of 5 students, everyone can take part in a discussion or role-play during one lesson. As a result, students increase their language output and become more

fluent and confident.

Secondly, teachers can give more attention to ^{单 ?? 单} each student in a small class. With fewer students, teachers can check everyone's work carefully. This helps students understand their errors and avoid repeating them. For instance, a teacher can focus on a student's pronunciation and give specific advice. Therefore, students can make steady progress and improve more effectively.

In conclusion, although larger classes may ^{be} cheaper than smaller classes, the ^{latter} ^{⇒ 它们发音不一样} provides more speaking opportunities and more individual attention for students. For these reasons, I believe smaller classes ^{are} ^{is} better for learning languages.

Title

Smaller Classes Is Better for
Language Learning

Smaller Classes → 复数 → are

Smaller Classes Are Better for
Language Learning

Introduction

Nowadays, many parents and

Nowadays, class size is an

teachers are discussing whether students should learn languages in smaller classes.	important factor that many people consider when learning languages.
--	--

Background 这句话，虽然有“whether”，但是重点已经在“smaller classes”上了

因为 Forrest 没有提到“bigger classes”做对比

不建议这样写 background ~

Some people believe larger classes are easy to study in groups. <u>While</u> others argue students can receive more attention from teacher.	Some people believe larger classes are easy to study in groups, <u>while</u> others argue <u>that</u> students can receive more attention from teacher in smaller classes.
--	---

① xxx, while xxx

While 不能单独开句!!

while 是连词 (conjunction)，不能像 However 那样单独开一个句子

② 前半句提到“bigger classes”的好处，后面应该要有“smaller classes”做对比，这样逻辑才会完整 ~

Body Paragraph 1

A: When there are fewer students, each person has more time to answer questions and practise conversations. B: It is very important for everyone to <u>take</u>	B: <u>When learning language, it</u> is very important for everyone to <u>get</u> more speaking practice. A: When there are fewer students, each person has more time to answer
---	---

more speaking practice.

questions and practise
conversations.

① “有更多口语练习（机会）”？

Take more speaking practice **X**

get more practice / have more chance to speak **V**

②

* Forrest 原句 → A → B

结论先行

* 修改后 → B → A

说明重要性 → 小班课如何实现这一点

分析部分如何更具体？

分析（抽象）和例子（具体）其实是相互对应的

practice → participation → confidence → fluency → real
communication ability

When learning languages, it is very important for everyone to get more speaking practice because language skills develop mainly through active use rather than passive listening. With more opportunities to speak, students can try out new vocabulary and sentence structures, which helps them remember the language more effectively (增加的内容). When there are fewer students, each person has more time to answer questions and practise conversations, allowing them to participate more actively and receive immediate feedback from the teacher. This process helps students correct their mistakes and improve their pronunciation, leading to greater

confidence (增加的内容).

Example 部分如何更具体?

For example, in a class of five students, everyone can take part in a discussion or role-play during one lesson. These role-plays can be based on real-life situations, such as ordering food in a restaurant or asking for directions while travelling, allowing students to practise useful expressions in meaningful contexts. Through repeated practice, students become more familiar with the language and learn how to respond naturally (增加的内容). As a result, students increase their language output and become more fluent and confident, which also helps them communicate more successfully in real-life situations outside the classroom (增加的内容).

Body Paragraph 2

Secondly, teachers can give more attention to each students in a small class.

Secondly, teachers can give more attention to each student in a small class.

① 单复数不对应

each → 单数

students → 复数

Conclusion

In conclusion, although larger classes es may cheaper than smaller classeses, the later provideses more speaking opportunities...

In conclusion, although larger classes may cheaper than smaller classes, the latter provides more speaking opportunities...

① 情态动词 (may/can/should/will) 后面必须接 动词原形 (base form)

* be 也是 be 动词的原型 ~

* cheaper 是形容词比较级, 前面是一定要有 be 动词的

② 主谓一致

larger classes / smaller classes 都是复数, provide 要用原型

③ later vs. latter

later /'leɪtə/ ★★★★★ | CET4 TEM4

1. **Later** is the comparative of . (late)的比较级
2. **ADV** You use **later** to refer to a time or situation that is after the one that you have been talking about or after the present one. 以后
 - He resigned ten years later.
他10年后辞职了。
3. **PHRASE** You use **later on** to refer to a time or situation that is after the one that you have been talking about or after the present one. 以后
 - Later on I'll be speaking to Patty Davis.
以后我会和帕蒂·戴维斯谈谈。
4. **ADJ** You use **later** to refer to an event, period of time, or other thing which comes after the one that you have been talking about or after the present one. 后来的
 - At a later news conference, he said differences should not be dramatized.
在后来的新闻发布会上, 他说差异不应该被夸大。

latter /'lætə/ ★★★★★☆ | CET4 TEM4

1. **PRON** When two people, things, or groups have just been mentioned, you can refer to the second of them as **the latter**. 后者
 - He tracked down his cousin and uncle. The latter was sick.
他追踪找到了他的堂兄和叔叔。后者病了。
2. **ADJ** **Latter** is also an adjective. 后面的
 - There are the people who speak after they think and the people who think while they're speaking. Mike definitely belongs in the latter category.
有些人先想后说, 有些人边想边说。迈克当然属于后一类人。

New Writing Task - In-class Practising

Is Social Media Harmful or Beneficial for Society?

Structure of an Academic Essay

Introduction	①Sets up the debate: gives context (why is this important?) ②Establishes the two opposing viewpoints ③States (or hints at) the author's argument (thesis)
Body Paragraph 1	①Gives arguments in favour of one side of the debate ②Back up by evidence
Body Paragraph 2	①Gives arguments for the other side of the debate ②Back up by evidence (sometimes with counter arguments). <u>** the point of view you support **</u>
Conclusion	①Evaluates the two sides of the debate ②Give a clear conclusion ③Explain: which argument is the strongest and why

开头 - 反对 - 支持 - 结尾 (支持) → 逻辑流畅

开头 - 支持 - 反对 - 结尾 (支持) → 逻辑跳跃

Introduction:

① background:

Social media has become an essential part of modern life, particularly for young people who rely heavily on it for communication, entertainment, and access to information.

② different views:

While many people argue that social media provides valuable opportunities for A and B (取决于 Forrest 的 body paragraph 1 讨论什么), particularly when used responsibly, others are increasingly concerned about its negative effects on teenagers' mental health, including A, B, and C (取决于 Forrest 的 body paragraph 2 讨论什么).

③ Forrest's opinion:

This essay will analyze/discuss both the benefits and drawbacks of social media from a psychological/mental perspectives, and give my own opinion / and argue that its negative effects on mental health are more significant/obvious.

Body Paragraph 1 (Benefits):

Point:

One major benefit of social media is its ability to strengthen relationships and provide emotional support.

OR

Supporters of social media emphasize its potential to strengthen relationships and provide emotional support.

Explanation:

Example:

Link/point (what is the result):

Body Paragraph 2 (Mental Harms):

Point:

However/On the other hand, there is substantial evidence that social media is associated with significant psychological risks.

Explanation:

Example:

Point/Link (what is the result):

Conclusion:

In conclusion, although social media provides valuable opportunities for connection and communication with friends in any distance, its negative psychological effects appear to outweigh its benefits, especially for young people/teenage. Problems such as A, B, and C (取决于 Forrest 的 body paragraph₂ 讨论什么) can have long-term consequences for individuals' well-being. Overall, this evidence indicates/suggests that social media may be more harmful than beneficial to society.

Homework 1 - ARTICLE

完成 P10 ~ 12 的 Article

Sources 中不同 highlight 所表示的内容:

绿色 highlight / 下划线	Forrest 最开始找的 quotes 比如: Four-in-ten or more teens say social media platforms hurt the amount of sleep they get (45%), as well as their productivity (40%). Small
蓝色 highlight	用在 body paragraph 1 - benefit 的内容 比如: creativity. Roughly three-quarters of teens (74%) say what they see on social media makes them feel more connected to what's going on in their friends' lives. And 63% say social media platforms are a place they can show their creative side.
红色 highlight	用在 body paragraph 2 - harms (psychological) 的内容 比如: 2. Comparison and Self-Esteem Issues: Social media often portrays idealized images of people's lives, leading to unrealistic expectations and comparisons. Young people may compare themselves to these curated images, resulting in feelings of inadequacy and low self-esteem. Studies